

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Consultant

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Microsoft Security Consultant and Engineer with over five years of experience designing, deploying and operationalising the full Microsoft security stack in complex enterprise environments. I have deep, hands-on expertise across Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory/Azure AD), Microsoft Intune, and Conditional Access. I led the deployment of the complete Microsoft Defender suite for an 8,000-user organisation, designed Microsoft Sentinel workspaces from the ground up, authored Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and automated response playbooks, and delivered the Identity and Access Management (IAM) strategy including Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO). I am a strong communicator with the ability to translate complex Microsoft security architecture into clear business outcomes. I am seeking a remote-first, client-facing consultant role where I can combine my Microsoft security engineering depth with a passion for helping organisations build resilient, modern security postures.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Workspace design, data connector configuration, KQL analytics rules, Logic Apps playbooks, workbooks, threat hunting — built from the ground up
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL — Strong):** Detection rule authoring, threat hunting queries, operational dashboards
- **Microsoft 365 Defender (M365 Defender):** Unified XDR platform — configuration, alert triage, investigation workflows, advanced hunting
- **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE):** Deployment, policy configuration, EDR alert investigation, attack surface reduction — 8,000-user rollout
- **Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI):** Deployment, alert triage, identity threat investigation, LDAP monitoring
- **Microsoft Defender for Cloud:** Cloud security posture management, workload protection, recommendation-driven remediation
- **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD):** Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Zero Trust architecture
- **Microsoft Intune:** Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), compliance policies, endpoint configuration profiles
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Logic Apps-based automation playbooks integrated with Microsoft Sentinel
- **CrowdStrike Falcon (Expert):** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover — complementary EDR platform expertise
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61; MITRE ATT&CK; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; Logic Apps
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, Zero Trust

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Designed and operates the organisation's **Microsoft Sentinel** workspace, including data connector configuration for Microsoft 365, Azure, CrowdStrike, Mimecast and on-premises sources; authors and

tunes KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK

- Builds and maintains **Logic Apps-based SOAR playbooks** integrated with Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment, identity isolation, and stakeholder notification workflows
- Manages the **Microsoft 365 Defender** unified XDR portal, administering alert policies, advanced hunting queries and cross-workload investigation workflows
- Leads **threat hunting** using KQL-based queries across Sentinel and the broader Microsoft Defender estate, identifying attacker techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK
- Serves as the **senior incident response escalation lead**, applying NIST 800-61 and Microsoft Defender native investigation tools to contain and remediate security incidents
- Manages the vulnerability management programme using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck; uses results to validate Microsoft Defender for Cloud security recommendations and drive remediation
- Develops PowerShell automation scripts and KQL-based operational dashboards for executive and governance reporting

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Led the end-to-end deployment of **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)** and **Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)** for an 8,000-user organisation, integrating both into the M365 Defender unified security operations platform
- Designed and enforced **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)** Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO and Privileged Identity Management (PIM), delivering a Zero Trust identity posture for all users
- Deployed and managed **Microsoft Intune** for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing compliance policies and device configuration profiles across corporate and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints
- Administered **Microsoft 365 security and compliance** tooling, including exchange protection policies, DLP rules and eDiscovery configurations
- Configured and maintained the initial **Microsoft Sentinel data connectors** and contributed to foundational KQL analytics rule development as part of the SOC build
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) alongside Microsoft Entra ID PIM to enforce least-privilege access across administrative accounts
- Supported incident response and contributed to the development of Microsoft Sentinel-integrated playbooks for automated response to common attack scenarios

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Supported Microsoft 365 and Azure environment security in a SaaS/FinTech environment, managing identity, access controls and endpoint security tooling
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate security and infrastructure operations tasks
- Supported penetration test remediation and ISO 27001 compliance activities, applying Microsoft security platform controls to address findings

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the full **Microsoft Defender suite deployment** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) for an 8,000-user organisation, delivering integrated XDR visibility across endpoints, identities and cloud workloads
- Designed and built a **Microsoft Sentinel workspace from the ground up**, including data connectors, KQL analytics rules, Logic Apps playbooks and operational workbooks, establishing a mature SIEM capability
- Delivered **Microsoft Entra ID Zero Trust architecture** using Conditional Access, MFA and PIM, materially reducing the organisation's identity attack surface
- Built a comprehensive **SOAR automation playbook library** in Logic Apps, reducing manual analyst effort for common alert types by automating enrichment, containment and notification actions
- Authored **incident response playbooks** tailored to Microsoft security platform alerts, enabling consistent and repeatable response across the SOC team

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)